

Open files need a destination

Positional Judgment

THE IDEA

A rook on an open file can pressure the opponent's position, but file control alone does not win. Find a penetration square, prepare support, and calculate exchanges. Sometimes a rook belongs behind a passed pawn instead.

WORKED EXAMPLE

If your rook enters the seventh rank, it may attack pawns from the side and restrict the enemy king. If entry simply allows a rook trade into a drawn ending, maintaining tension may be stronger.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What should you name before committing both rooks to one file?

ANSWER AND REASONING

The intended entry square and the target after entry. Then inspect how the opponent can contest the file or exchange the attacking rooks.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

A rook operation needs a destination and a reason to go there.